SHAHRAM AJLOO

Maintenance and tooling leadership · Equipment availability in defence production

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Terma A/S · Lystrup, Denmark · Maintenance & Tooling Manager

Application: Maintenance & Tooling Manager

Dear Hiring Manager

In defence production, the maintenance and tooling departments are not support functions. A machine that stands still for a day is not an inconvenience — it is a delivery commitment to a customer who audits us, and a tool that is not available stops a line even when every machine is running. So I would run the two departments against one number that production actually feels: availability. Of the machines, of the tools, and of the people who keep them running.

The system I would put in place has four parts, and none of them needs a new platform. First, criticality: every asset assessed for what its failure would do to delivery, quality and safety — and the critical ones given a written preventive standard saying what is checked, how often, by whom and with what evidence. Second, the CMMS as the single source of truth: every work order and every hour of downtime with a coded reason, so MTBF and MTTR come out of the system instead of out of somebody's memory. Third, tooling treated as a production resource rather than as equipment: a register with condition and calibration status, a repair and modification pipeline run with the Senior Tooling Specialist, and an availability target agreed with production. Fourth, a weekly planning conversation where preventive and corrective work are traded openly with production — instead of preventive maintenance being what gets cancelled first.

Around that sit the things that actually move downtime: a critical-spares list based on lead time and consequence rather than habit, standard fault-finding for the failure modes that cause most of the hours, TPM and 5S at the machine so operators catch deviations before the technician is called, and A3 with 5 Whys for every repeat failure — closed when the countermeasure has held for a month, not when the ticket is closed. Supplier management belongs in the same routine: technical specification, FAT and SAT, documented acceptance, and follow-up on response time and quality.

What I bring is the technical depth and the leadership the role describes. I am an authorised marine engineer — maskinmester with electrical authorisation — with a B.Tech in Technology Management and Mechanical Engineering, the foundation the posting asks for. At Biofos I ran maintenance and operations on a 24/7 plant — pumps, HVAC, high-voltage switchgear, SCADA condition monitoring, LOTO, APV and near-miss routines — and a PDCA programme cut energy cost by 40 %. At Novo Nordisk I worked inside GMP/FDA/EMA requirements across 37 parallel capital projects with 25 specialists — documented acceptance criteria, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ and audited handover with zero critical findings. At ARJ Engineering I led twelve mechanics and technicians in a machine workshop with shift planning, fault diagnosis and corrective actions on industrial production equipment. For three years I have run my own company with full P&L, five electricians and three apprentices — so I know what an idle technician costs and what it takes to keep one.

Two teams also means one rhythm: a shared weekly capacity and priority board — what is planned, what is unplanned, who is where, and what we are deliberately not doing this week — because the fastest way to lose a technician is to give him three priorities. Under it a competence matrix covering electrical, mechanical, CNC, automation and hydraulics, a named second person for every critical skill, and 1:1s every two weeks; your own value puts it better: we develop people and technology.

I will be straight about what is new. I have not worked in defence manufacturing before, and I have not run a tooling department in an aerospace supply chain with the traceability that follows from it. My maintenance side comes from a 24/7 process plant, my production-equipment side from a machine workshop and from validation work in pharmaceutical production, and tooling is the part I would learn fastest by standing next to your Senior Tooling Specialist in the first weeks. I am also ready to go through the security clearance process with the Danish Defence Intelligence Service in full, and I am not aware of anything that would stand in the way.

What draws me to Terma is that the purpose is not a poster. Equipment reliability here decides whether a radar, a self-protection system or an aerostructure reaches the people who depend on it. I also recognise the culture you describe — trust, collaboration, knowledge sharing, and a company that has just moved from number 30 to number 16 among engineering professionals. That is the kind of department I want to lead.

Practically: I live in Måløv, about 40 minutes by car from Lystrup. I speak Danish natively and English professionally. I am also an active Claude coder and build my own Python tools for reliability follow-up — downtime and MTBF dashboards, spare-parts criticality, and investment cases with NPV, IRR, sensitivity and scenarios when a machine is to be replaced.

I would like to come to Lystrup, walk the production floor and the tooling store with you, and talk through the first ninety days and where I see the biggest availability gains.

Kind regards

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PROFILE

Maintenance and production leader with 20+ years from technical operations, production equipment and projects — authorised marine engineer (maskinmester) with electrical authorisation and a B.Tech in Technology Management and Mechanical Engineering. Five years of maintenance responsibility on a 24/7 plant, two years of equipment qualification under GMP/FDA/EMA, and three years of full P&L in his own technical company. Works from a register, a standard and a number: criticality, preventive standards, CMMS discipline and MTBF/MTTR rather than anecdotes.

MAINTENANCE, TOOLING AND RESULTS

- **Equipment availability and preventive maintenance:** Five years of maintenance responsibility on a 24/7 plant: pumps, HVAC, high-voltage switchgear and SCADA-monitored equipment. Preventive maintenance from condition data and corrective work prioritised by consequence.
- **Technical teams led:** Twelve mechanics and technicians in a machine workshop; 25 specialists across 37 capital projects; five electricians and three apprentices with full personnel responsibility.
- **Tooling, workshop and production equipment:** Workshop and machine-park responsibility: fault diagnosis, root-cause analysis and corrective actions on industrial production equipment; jigs, fixtures and test equipment specified and commissioned.
- **Supplier and service management:** Technical specification, FAT/SAT and documented acceptance of equipment, suppliers and service partners under GMP/FDA/EMA.
- **Continuous improvement with measured effect:** PDCA, 5S, standard work, VSM, A3 and 5 Whys in daily use. A PDCA programme cut energy cost by 40 %; own Python/Claude tools took over 40 % of the administrative work out of quoting and KPI follow-up.

TOOLS AND METHODS

Task	Tool and documented use
Asset reliability	Asset register with criticality, preventive standards, failure mode analysis (FMEA) and MTBF/MTTR per asset.
CMMS and work orders	CMMS as single source of truth: work orders, coded downtime reasons and spare-parts consumption per asset. SAP ERP for assets, materials and cost.
Tooling control	Tool register with condition, calibration and location; repair and modification pipeline with owner and deadline; availability target agreed with production.
Continuous improvement	PDCA, 5S, TPM, standard work, VSM, Kaizen, A3 and 5 Whys with verified countermeasures; a limited project funnel with business case and measured effect.
Safety and compliance	LOTO, APV/workplace assessment, risk assessment, near-miss reporting and safety walks; documented procedures and audit readiness under GMP/FDA/EMA.
People management	Situational Leadership (SLII), delegation ladder, 1:1s every two weeks, reviews, GROW and SBI feedback, competence matrix and apprentice development to trade test.

EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen, Denmark · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians and 3 apprentices · full P&L · commercial and industrial customers

- **Commercial and operational ownership:** Quoting, pricing, margin follow-up and service agreements with response time, quality and delivery as KPIs.
- **People and safety:** Daily planning, 1:1s, reviews, coaching of a field-based team, competence matrix and apprentice training; LOTO, risk assessment and APV at every site start.
- **Digital tools:** Python and Claude API for quotations, scheduling, quality checklists and KPI dashboards; productivity gain above 40 % in the business.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager, electrical systems — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg / Bagsværd, Denmark · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 capital projects · 25 specialists · DKK 2–10m each · GMP/FDA/EMA

- **Equipment and supplier qualification:** FAT/SAT and IQ/OQ/PQ with documented acceptance criteria, deviation handling and audited handover; zero critical findings at handover.
- **Performance and improvement:** Progress, cost, risk and resources across engineering, procurement and operations; A3 and 5 Whys in fault finding.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek-Air · Copenhagen, Denmark · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 employees · 11 parallel construction projects · DKK 2–10m each

- **Throughput and flow:** Tenders, quotations, subcontractors and handover packages. Daily board meetings, bottleneck analysis and standardised routines lifted delivery performance.

Maintenance and Operations Manager / Workshop Technician — Biofos, Lynetten · Copenhagen, Denmark · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: 24/7 plant · pumps, HVAC, switchgear, SCADA · shifts including nights and weekends

- **Preventive and corrective maintenance:** Preventive maintenance planned from SCADA condition data; spare-parts flow with min/max levels; downtime reasons recorded and followed.
- **Safety and standards:** LOTO, risk assessment, APV and near-miss reporting in shift operations; standard work, 5S and PDCA on the workshop and stores.

Electromechanical Technician / Production Team Leader — ARJ Engineering · Tehran, Iran · Dec 2003–Mar 2010

Scope: 12 mechanics and technicians · machine workshop · industrial equipment

- **Production equipment and targets:** Shift planning, material control and target follow-up; fault diagnosis, root-cause analysis and corrective actions on industrial machinery and production lines.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

B.Tech, Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering · Copenhagen School of Marine Engineering & Technology Management · 2017–2022 · EQF 6 · GPA 7.6/12

Authorised marine and electrical engineer (LV/MV/HV) · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Electrical and mechanical design, electrical engineering · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003 · EQF 6

Refrigeration and air conditioning · STCW safety and engine-room watch · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021–2023

LANGUAGES, PRACTICAL AND REFERENCES

Danish: native · English: professional · Persian: native · Driving licence B · Lives in Måløv, about 40 minutes by car from Lystrup; relocation not required · Ready to go through the security clearance process · References from Novo Nordisk and Biofos on request.

WHAT THE ROLE ASKS FOR — MY EVIDENCE

Requirement	Evidence
Relevant technical education — marine, mechanical or production engineer	Authorised marine engineer (maskinmester) with electrical authorisation LV/MV/HV and B.Tech in Technology Management and Mechanical Engineering (EQF 6) — the foundation the posting describes.
Experience from maintenance, tooling, production engineering or similar	Five years of maintenance and operations on a 24/7 plant; workshop and machine-park responsibility; two years of equipment qualification under GMP/FDA/EMA. Aerospace tooling is new to me.
Strong leadership of technical teams	Twelve mechanics and technicians; 25 specialists across 37 projects; a 14-person team; five electricians and three apprentices with full personnel responsibility including hiring, reviews and employee development.
Solid understanding of production equipment and maintenance processes	Preventive standards, criticality, CMMS discipline, MTBF/MTTR, critical spares, fault diagnosis and root cause on pumps, HVAC, switchgear and machine tools; daily work with contractors and service partners.
Structured, proactive, able to prioritise in a dynamic production environment	Weekly capacity and priority board, 12-week resource planning and a written "what we are not doing this week" list; escalation by exception; five years of 24/7 operations.
Danish and English at professional level	Danish native, English professional written and spoken; two years in an international project organisation with English as the working language.
Maintenance management, CMMS, automation, CNC and technical supplier management	CMMS and SAP as daily systems; CNC and automation equipment maintained in workshop and plant settings; supplier selection and FAT/SAT documented across 37 projects.
Security clearance by the Danish Defence Intelligence Service	Ready to go through the process in full and provide the documentation it requires; no known impediments.

FIRST 90 DAYS — ASSETS, TOOLING, TEAMS

Period	What happens, and how it is measured
Week 1–2	On the floor at every production area with the technicians: machine park, tooling store, calibration, spare-parts store and the maintenance workshop. 1:1 with every technician and with the Senior Tooling Specialist. Systems walk-through: CMMS, work-order backlog, PM plans and open deviations.
Day 30	One-page baseline written: availability per line, PM compliance, open corrective backlog, MTTR and MTBF for the ten most critical assets, tooling availability, and where the hours actually go. Criticality list agreed with the Senior Manager Production Equipment.
Day 60	Preventive standards rewritten for the critical assets and loaded in the CMMS. Coded downtime reasons in use, so MTBF/MTTR are system numbers rather than estimates. Tooling register complete with condition, calibration and repair pipeline. Weekly capacity and priority board running for both departments.
Day 90	Measured movement in PM compliance and in availability on at least two critical lines. Critical-spares list and min/max levels agreed. Competence matrix for both departments with a named second person for every critical skill, and a training plan for the year. A written handover of the routine, so it does not depend on me being in the building.

HOW EQUIPMENT AVAILABILITY IS ACTUALLY BUILT

Availability is not the absence of breakdowns; it is the sum of small decisions made before the breakdown. Which assets matter, what is done to them and how often, whether the spare is on the shelf when the lead time is twelve weeks, whether the operator notices the noise on Tuesday instead of the stop on Friday, and whether the repeat failure is actually fixed or just restarted. That is why I start with criticality and a written standard rather than with a new tool: a preventive plan that nobody can audit is a wish, and a CMMS filled in after the fact is a diary, not a control system.

TOOLING AS A PRODUCTION RESOURCE

Tooling is where a factory loses hours that no maintenance report shows, because the machines are running and the work still cannot start. So tooling gets the same treatment as the machine park: a register that is complete and trusted, a preventive and calibration cycle tied to use rather than to the calendar alone, a repair and modification pipeline with an owner and a date, and an availability target that production and tooling have agreed on together. The Senior Tooling Specialist owns the technical judgement; my job is to make sure priorities, capacity and escalation support that judgement instead of working around it — and that improvements to a tool are recorded, so the next one is better.

IMPROVEMENT THAT SHOWS UP IN NUMBERS

I keep a short improvement funnel — five projects at a time, no more — each with an owner, a business case and a measured effect. In maintenance the candidates are usually the same everywhere: the twenty per cent of failure modes that cause most of the downtime, spare-parts availability against lead time, the handover between shifts, and the quality of the fault description that reaches the technician. PDCA, A3 and 5 Whys are the tools, but the discipline is verification: a countermeasure is closed when the number has held for a month, not when the work order is signed.

SAFETY, QUALITY AND THE DEFENCE CONTEXT

In a defence company, maintenance work is also a security and quality question. Work on production equipment happens under documented procedures, with change control before anything is altered, with traceability of what was done and by whom, and with LOTO, risk assessment, APV and near-miss reporting as daily routines rather than campaigns. I have worked this way under GMP, FDA and EMA, where a missing signature stops a release, and in 24/7 operations where a shortcut costs an injury. The vocabulary changes in aerospace; the discipline does not.

TWO DEPARTMENTS, ONE RHYTHM

Maintenance and Tooling will always compete for the same technicians, the same hours and the same goodwill from production and from stakeholders across the plant. Two departments with two separate priority lists is how that competition becomes friction. So one weekly board, one list of priorities agreed with the Senior Manager Production Equipment and production, one escalation route, and a monthly review where each department reports three numbers and one improvement. The rest is leadership: 1:1s, a competence matrix that shows who can do what on which equipment, a named second person for every critical skill, and technicians who are trained on the next machine rather than only on the one they already know.

DIGITAL WORK AND AI

I am an active Claude coder and build my own tools in Python: downtime and MTBF follow-up pulled from several sources into one page, spare-parts criticality against lead time and consumption, tooling status lists, and investment cases with NPV, IRR, sensitivity and scenarios when a machine is replaced or capacity is expanded. None of it replaces the CMMS — it makes the numbers in it readable in minutes, which is usually the difference between a report that is used and a report that is filed.